~/the-commit $ git log --since="2026-11-02" --oneline HEAD → 1274dc6

The Commit

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COVER STORY · DATA CENTERS

Voters put brakes on data center expansion

Local ballots reveal resistance to construction across ten states, adding political obstacles to the technology industry's infrastructure buildout.

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Communities voted against data center development in nearly every reported local contest. The results show how decisions about the industry's physical footprint are becoming a force in American elections.

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01 COVER STORY Data centers

Voters put brakes on data center expansion

Local ballots reveal resistance to construction across ten states, adding political obstacles to the technology industry's infrastructure buildout.

src: cnbc.com · 4 min read

Voters backed restrictions on data centers or rejected measures supporting development in nearly every local contest with results available on Wednesday, CNBC reported. Ballotpedia counted 41 related ballot measures across ten states in the midterm elections. Harwood, North Dakota, was the exception: voters rejected an additional review of industrial projects, including data centers.

Ohio accounted for 21 measures, more than half the total. Communities in states including California, Florida, Illinois and Wisconsin also voted on the issue. The measures concerned restrictions on construction in different forms, so the result is a collection of local decisions rather than one national prohibition.

The backlash reached prominent statewide races too. Democrat Sherrod Brown defeated Republican Senator Jon Husted after portraying him as the face of data centers. In Texas, Gina Hinojosa unseated Governor Greg Abbott after attacking his support for their rapid buildout. Together, the results suggest that securing sites for technology infrastructure now carries an electoral dimension: local opposition can shape both construction rules and the politicians responsible for them.

02 TECH RADAR

Phone attacks used patched flaws

Researchers linked a phone hacking campaign to Russian intelligence with moderate to high confidence. Already patched iOS and Android vulnerabilities left outdated devices exposed.

src: arstechnica.com

Apple plans public-link checks

Apple says publicly shared iCloud photos and files will become accessible for harmful-content checks in its 27.3 updates. Treatment of existing links remains unspecified.

src: macrumors.com

Cyberattack reaches British cold storage

Britain's food supply chain was affected by attacks on connected refrigeration. A trade association reported defrosting units, showing how compromised controls can threaten physical goods.

src: bbc.co.uk

FCC nomination hearing set

Ted Cruz scheduled a November 10 hearing for Danielle Thumann Severs. Confirmation would give Republicans a 3–1 FCC majority before Democrats take Senate control.

src: arstechnica.com

03 AI School technology

Google ties school search to AI acceptance

From early 2027, schools enabling Google Search for students will have to accept an AI version.

src: the-decoder.com · 2026-11-04

Google will stop offering schools a version of student search without AI in early 2027, The Decoder reports, citing reporting by The New York Times. Gemini, Gemini Notebook and Google Search will initially be disabled for student accounts. Schools may enable each separately, but switching search back on will also mean accepting AI features.

Schools will have two search options: full AI overviews and AI chat, or Guided Learning, which is designed to help students work toward answers rather than supply them directly. Google's education vice president Chris Phillips said search and AI had become too closely integrated to separate.

The change follows a reversal elsewhere. Google had enabled AI features by default in Classroom for schools with Gemini access, drawing criticism; it is now reversing that decision. The new search arrangement still leaves administrators choosing between AI-enabled search and no Google Search for student accounts.

New York City and Los Angeles, the country's two largest school districts, had already pulled back on student AI in September. Los Angeles wanted to retain search without AI overviews. Under the reported policy, that particular choice disappears.

04 MODEL WATCH

Mon 2 → Thu 5 Nov

NEW FROM THE LABS	SIZE	CAPABILITIES
Kimi K3.1 Pro MOONSHOT AI · 2 NOV	2.8T 104B active	
Timestral-123M MISTRAL · 14 OCT	123M	
Qwen-Image-2.1-Turbo QWEN · 9 OCT	7.1B	

TRENDING ON HUGGING FACE	SIZE	CAPABILITIES
Qwen3.8-27B QWEN · #11	27.8B	
SenseNova-Loop-9B-Preview SENSENOVA · #17	9.7B	
LFM3-Omni-2B LIQUID AI · #24	2.17B	

Vision · Coding · Agents & tool use · Speech & audio · Image generation · Open weights

06 SEMICONDUCTORS Mon 2 → Thu 5 Nov

MEMORY MANUFACTURING

Micron maps memory's next manufacturing steps

Its roadmap combines new materials, wafer bonding and future 3D DRAM, with firm production timing still limited.

src: tomshardware.com · 2026-11-04

Micron is changing how it plans to shrink memory, abandoning a proposed smaller DRAM cell design while pursuing wafer bonding, new materials and eventually 3D DRAM. Tom's Hardware reports that its next 1-delta process is in the yield-ramp stage, with mass production scheduled for the second half of 2027.

The distinction matters: Micron's current 1-gamma technology is already in high-volume manufacturing, while later generations remain in development. Micron expects 1-delta to increase bit density by a percentage in the mid-twenties over 1-gamma. It plans US manufacturing and products spanning conventional memory, graphics and stacked high-bandwidth memory.

Further out, Micron intends to introduce High-NA extreme-ultraviolet lithography, a more advanced chip-patterning technique, but has not disclosed mass-production timing or density gains. Two 3D DRAM generations would add cells vertically instead of relying only on smaller cells. Their architectures and layer counts remain undisclosed; Micron says adoption depends on competitive cost and performance.

07 CHIP BRIEFING

Samsung's Texas memory orders remain unconfirmed

SemiMedia, citing Maeil Business Newspaper's industry sources, reports AMD accounts for most booked HBM base-die volume at Samsung's planned Taylor Fab 2. Samsung declined to confirm customers. Construction is scheduled to begin this month, with mass production in 2030: reported orders concern future capacity, rather than current output.

src: semimedia.cc

Entegris adds diamond materials capabilities

Entegris says it completed its acquisition of Advanced Abrasives and entered a development partnership with synthetic-diamond producer Element Six. The aim is better heat management in advanced AI chip packaging. A proposed Taiwan manufacturing line and diamond integration work are investments and development plans; the announcement supplies no measured thermal gains.

src: semiconductor-digest.com

Bosch gives chips a dedicated division

Bosch says it will move semiconductor operations into a dedicated division from January 2028, remaining within its Mobility business. It targets about €5 billion in semiconductor sales by 2030 and plans to expand foundry work for external customers. This is an organizational and commercial plan, rather than newly commissioned production capacity.

src: semiconductor-digest.com

08 EXPLAINER full piece ~2 min

OPEN AI

Token counts cannot size the open model economy

Usage disclosures show activity, but incomplete coverage and incompatible measures make market size harder to establish.

src: interconnects.ai · Interconnects · 2026-11-04

How large is the business of running open AI models? An Interconnects research note approaches that question through the companies serving them. Its warning is as useful as its growth figures: public evidence mixes noisy platform statistics, startup marketing disclosures and imperfect evaluations. Those measures can indicate direction without providing a complete account of the market.

The note uses Baseten, Fireworks and Together AI as indicators because their fortunes are closely connected to open model inference: running models to produce responses. It also tracks open models' share of the token volume reported through OpenRouter's API. These sources offer views into particular businesses and platforms, rather than a census of every place open models run.

Coverage is a central limitation. The author says major cloud providers probably have a substantial footprint, pointing to Amazon Bedrock and Azure's model garden, but has not seen them separate usage by model category. A comparison built from specialist startups therefore leaves important activity outside the measured picture. That missing breakdown prevents a clean comparison of open and closed model use.

Even a striking disclosure needs its denominator. Fireworks said at its company conference that it serves more than 40 trillion tokens daily to customers' customized models, a category it said had grown more than twice since summer. The author expects total volume to be much higher, but that expectation is an estimate, distinct from the disclosed figure.

The note also compares disclosures with Google's platform and API token counts. Such comparisons help put activity in perspective, but the underlying categories still matter. For readers assessing claims about an open model boom, the useful questions are what was counted, which providers were omitted and whether a number was reported or inferred. Growth evidence and a reliable market total are different achievements.

BYTE-SIZED JOKE

My smart fridge asked for a holiday. I told it to chill.

09 COMPANY ACTIONS Mon 2 → Thu 5 Nov

Data centers drive record revenue

AMD reported record third-quarter revenue of $13.4 billion, up 45% from a year earlier. Data center sales rose 97% to $8.5 billion, which AMD attributed to server processors and its Instinct MI450 launch. Gaming revenue fell 40% to $773 million. Its roughly $17 billion fourth-quarter revenue guidance signals further acceleration, but remains a forecast rather than a completed result.

AMD · arstechnica.com

Lumentum deal pairs chips with optics

Marvell agreed to buy Lumentum in an all-stock transaction valued at $115 billion using reference prices. The combination would join custom chips and interconnects with lasers and optical modules for AI infrastructure. The companies forecast over $1 billion in annual cost savings. Closing is expected in early 2028, subject to shareholder votes and regulatory clearances; the acquisition is not complete.

M MARVELL · semimedia.cc

Prime adds Uber Eats ordering

US Prime members can now order Uber Eats restaurant deliveries through Amazon's app or website, using existing payment details without creating an Uber account. Orders of at least $25 qualify for waived delivery fees. Other charges, including service fees, tips and menu markups, remain. The partnership gives Uber access to Prime shoppers while making Amazon another entry point for takeout.

A AMAZON · theverge.com

Conductor acquisition brings a cloud shutdown

Meta acquired Conductor, whose software coordinates coding agents in separate workspaces. Founder Charlie Holtz says core features will continue working until early next year, with a new interface planned by then. Its cloud service will close on November 20, after which deletion of cloud data begins. Users therefore face an immediate service transition alongside the promise of a future product.

META · techcrunch.com

Paid subscriptions pass 30 million

Snap says paid subscribers across Snapchat+, Memories Storage and Lens+ have exceeded 30 million. Its chief executive credited AI-powered Lens+ features with helping demand, while saying paid users remain a small share of the monthly community. The expansion follows restrictions on free Memories storage. Advertising growth remains below Snap's target, making subscriptions another business line as it works to improve advertiser performance.

S SNAP · techcrunch.com

Switch 2 sales fall after price increases

Nintendo sold 2.67 million Switch 2 consoles in the quarter ended September 30, down 41% from a year earlier, CNBC reports. The company raised prices amid higher memory costs but retained its fiscal-year sales forecast of 16.5 million units. Investors are looking to the newly released Ocarina of Time remake for a boost; that hoped-for recovery has yet to appear.

N NINTENDO · cnbc.com

10 COMPANY ACTIONS CONTINUED

Mon 2 → Thu 5 Nov

China blocks ABB robotics acquisition

China's state planner has told SoftBank that its $5.4 billion acquisition of ABB's robotics business cannot proceed, ABB said. The decision interrupts a deal central to SoftBank chief Masayoshi Son's ambitions in robotics, which he has described as part of the company's AI investment strategy. The South China Morning Post places it alongside China's earlier order for Meta to unwind its acquisition of Manus. That comparison shows scrutiny extending to another major technology transaction, although the supplied report does not explain the planner's reasoning or describe a route to revive the ABB deal.

S SOFTBANK · scmp.com

Data center forecasts offset smartphone weakness

Qualcomm is looking to data center chips as smartphone sales fall around 20% from 2025, The Verge reports. In its earnings call, the company forecast about $650 million in data center revenue for the first quarter of 2027, with ambitions reaching $5 billion by the end of that year and $15 billion by 2029. It expects the business eventually to represent around 30% of its total. Partnerships with Amazon and Meta underpin the push, but those revenue figures describe management's expectations. The diversification effort will depend on turning the announced relationships into a much larger stream of sales.

Q QUALCOMM · theverge.com

11 MARKETS

2 Nov → 4 Nov

S&P 500	NASDAQ	EURO STOXX 50	BITCOIN
▲ +1.9%	▲ +2.3%	▲ +1.4%	▲ +4.9%
7,689	25,737	6,266	80,405

▲ BIGGEST GAINERS			▼ BIGGEST LOSERS		
+9.9%	Coinbase COIN	$152	−4.6%	Tesla TSLA	$385
+9.6%	Microsoft MSFT	$556	−3.7%	Palantir PLTR	$172
+8.3%	Amazon AMZN	$266	−2.8%	Intel INTC	$58.27

Change between daily closes · finance.yahoo.com · not investment advice

12 WORLD REPORT Mon 2 → Thu 5 Nov

Democrats win Congress, with limits

Democrats will control both chambers of Congress from January after their midterm victory, the BBC reports. That gives them investigative powers and the ability to block presidential nominations. President Donald Trump can still reject legislation, limiting their legislative ambitions. Conviction after impeachment requires 67 Senate votes, a threshold the BBC says is likely to remain beyond their reach.

UNITED STATES · bbc.co.uk

Joshua Wong receives another decade in prison

Hong Kong activist Joshua Wong was sentenced to ten years for colluding with foreign forces under the national security law. He pleaded guilty in September. Prosecutors said he helped lobby for foreign sanctions and blockades. Already imprisoned for subversion, he had been due for release in January. His US-based fellow activist Frances Hui condemned the sentence; Beijing supported it.

HONG KONG · bbc.co.uk

Police footage follows deadly shelter strikes

Ukrainian police released bodycam footage they say shows the interval between Russian strikes that killed at least 40 people at an aid centre and shelter in Kamyshuvakha. President Volodymyr Zelensky said more than 30 others might remain beneath rubble. Ukraine said nine aerial bombs hit the village. Rescue searches continued for a third day, according to the BBC.

UKRAINE · bbc.co.uk

El Niño intensifies a damaging storm season

Repeated powerful storms have killed dozens and damaged crops and infrastructure across East Asia, the BBC reports. El Niño's warmer Pacific waters and altered winds are helping storms form farther east and strengthen over warm seas. The UK Met Office forecasts an exceptionally strong El Niño lasting into February or March, leaving the region exposed beyond the usual seasonal peak.

EAST ASIA · bbc.co.uk

Offensive settles into war of attrition

A month after Yemen's internationally recognised government launched an offensive to retake Houthi-held territory, researchers describe a prolonged war of attrition. Saudi-backed government forces aim to recover Sanaa, held by the Houthis since 2014. Al Jazeera reports Houthi gains elsewhere, including Taiz and Lahij. Residents of the capital fear fighting near their homes as the conflict remains unresolved.

YEMEN · aljazeera.com

Displaced families face winter on exposed beaches

Families living in damaged tents along Gaza's coast told Al Jazeera they cannot afford safer shelter before winter. Residents are using earth-filled cooking pots as barriers against seawater. Gaza's Winter Emergency Committee warns that about 7,800 tents occupy hazardous sites, including beaches and flood-prone areas. The committee says shortages of shelter and restrictions on supplies are worsening the danger.

GAZA · aljazeera.com